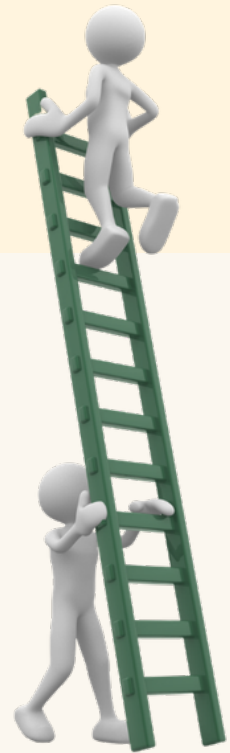


English Ladder

Teaching Guide

Understanding Events & Tenses in English

A concise classroom guide with lesson flow, teaching cues, and a ready-to-use answer key built around the same English Ladder concept sheet.



Grammar Concepts #14

Key Points

Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Understanding Events & Tenses in English** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept #14 ► **Events & Tenses**

Here are a few examples of ways to talk about two events from different temporal (time) perspectives.

 2018 Martin marries	• Martin graduated <u>5 years prior to</u> marrying.
	• Martin married <u>5 years after</u> he graduated.
	• Martin married <u>3 years ago</u> and graduated <u>8 years ago</u> .
 2013 Martin graduates	• Martin will marry <u>5 years after</u> his graduation.
	• Martin graduated <u>5 years before</u> he plans to marry.
	• Martin graduated <u>3 years ago</u> . He'll marry <u>2 years from now</u> . It has been <u>3 years since</u> Martin's graduation. <u>Two years from now</u> , Martin will marry.
 2010	• Martin will graduate <u>5 years before</u> he marries.
	• Martin will marry <u>5 years after</u> he graduates.
	• Martin will graduate <u>in 2 years</u> and marry <u>7 years from now</u> .
2008	

Remember that if the reference point is now, we use **ago** and **from now/in**. For other times we use **before/prior to** and **after**.

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At a Glance

Lesson focus Understanding Events & Tenses in English	Suggested timing 45-60 minutes
Core objective Students explain the target pattern clearly and apply it accurately in controlled practice and discussion.	Materials Student PDF, the concept image, board space, and time for partner checking.

Suggested Lesson Flow

Warm-up

Display the concept image and ask learners to predict the rule behind **Understanding Events & Tenses in English** before reading the explanation.

Model

Walk through the Core Idea and the sections on Key Points. Pause after each part so students can restate the pattern in plain English.

Guided practice

Project two or three examples from the concept sheet and ask pairs to explain why each choice works, not just what the answer is.

Independent work

Assign the 24 practice items for quiet work, partner checking, and final feedback.

Closure

Ask students to create one new sentence or mini-example of their own that follows the same pattern.

Likely Learner Errors

- Learners may overgeneralize the first pattern they notice. Keep returning to **Key Points** and ask students to explain what changes from one example to the next.
- Long explanations can hide the signal word or structure. Have students underline the exact phrase that tells them which form, pattern, or response is needed.
- If students can choose an answer but cannot explain it, ask them to justify their choice using words taken directly from the concept sheet.

Differentiation and Delivery Notes



- Support: teach one section at a time, then send students back to **the examples** or the practice set so they can apply the same rule immediately.
- Pair work: let students compare answers aloud before you reveal the key. The explanation step is as important as the final answer.
- Extension: ask stronger students to write two fresh examples or a short dialogue that uses the same target language accurately.

Model Language from the Concept Sheet

- Maria learned Spanish 3 years prior to moving to Spain.
- Alex started his business 2 years after finishing college.
- Julia visited Paris 2 years ago and graduated from university 5 years ago.
- Sarah will travel to Japan 1 year after she gets her passport.
- David bought a house 2 years before he plans to retire.
- Emily started her job 4 years ago. She plans to start her own business 3 years from now.



Answer Key

Use this key for whole-class feedback or fast marking.

Item 01 prior Explanation: "Prior to" means before a certain time or event. "Ago" is incorrect because it is used with a specific point in time in the past, not before another event. "Since" is incorrect because it is used to indicate the time from a past event to the present.

Item 02 after Explanation: "After" is used to indicate that one event happened following another. "Ago" is incorrect because it is used to specify how long before the present something happened. "Before" is incorrect because it would suggest the business was started before finishing college, which changes the meaning.

Item 03 ago, ago Explanation: "Ago" is used to indicate a time period that has passed from the present moment. "Before" and "after" are incorrect because they compare two events relative to each other, not relative to the present moment.

Item 04 after Explanation: "After" is correct to show that Sarah's travel happens following the event of getting her passport. "Ago" is incorrect because it refers to past time. "Before" is incorrect because it would mean she travels before getting her passport.

Item 05 before Explanation: "Before" indicates that the house purchase happened prior to his retirement. "After" is incorrect because it would mean he bought the house following his retirement. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed since a past event.

Item 06 ago, from Explanation: "Ago" indicates past time, while "from now" indicates future time from the present moment. "Before" and "after" do not fit because they do not indicate past or future relative to now.

Item 07 since Explanation: "Since" is used to indicate the time that has passed from a specific event until now. "Ago" is incorrect because it would mean 6 months before now, not since a specific event. "Before" is incorrect because it does not indicate ongoing time from a past event.

Item 08 from Explanation: "From now" is used to indicate future time measured from the present moment. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed since a past event.

Item 09 before Explanation: "Before" indicates that finishing the book happens prior to its publication. "After" is incorrect because it would mean she finishes the book following its publication. "Since" is incorrect because it indicates time passed from a past event to the present.

Item 10 after Explanation: "After" is used to show that the travel happens following the completion of his degree. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Before" is incorrect because it would mean he travels before completing his degree.

Item 11 from Explanation: "From now" indicates the future time measured from the present moment. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed from a past event



to the present.

Item 12 after Explanation: "After" indicates that the marriage happens following the graduation. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Before" is incorrect because it would mean he marries before graduating.

Item 13 before Explanation: "Before" shows that the graduation happened prior to the planned marriage. "After" is incorrect because it would mean he graduated following his marriage. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed from a past event to the present.

Item 14 ago, from Explanation: "Ago" indicates past time, while "from now" indicates future time measured from the present moment. "Before" and "after" do not fit because they do not indicate past or future relative to now.

Item 15 since Explanation: "Since" is used to indicate the time that has passed from a specific event until now. "Ago" is incorrect because it means a specific time before now, not ongoing time. "Before" is incorrect because it does not indicate ongoing time from a past event.

Item 16 from Explanation: "From now" is used to indicate future time measured from the present moment. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed from a past event to the present.

Item 17 before Explanation: "Before" indicates that the graduation happens prior to the marriage. "After" is incorrect because it would mean he graduates following his marriage. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed from a past event to the present.

Item 18 after Explanation: "After" indicates that the marriage happens following the graduation. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Before" is incorrect because it would mean he marries before graduating.

Item 19 from Explanation: "From now" is used to indicate future time measured from the present moment. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed from a past event to the present.

Item 20 ago, from Explanation: "Ago" is used to indicate a time period that has passed from the present moment. "From now" indicates future time measured from the present moment. "Before" and "after" do not fit because they do not indicate past or future relative to now.

Item 21 from, after Explanation: "From now" indicates future time measured from the present moment. "After" indicates that the presentation happens following the project completion. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Before" is incorrect in this context because it would change the sequence of events.

Item 22 since Explanation: "Since" is used to indicate the time that has passed from a specific event until now. "Ago" is incorrect because it means a specific time before now, not ongoing time. "Before" is incorrect because it does not indicate ongoing time from a past event.



Item 23 from Explanation: "From now" is used to indicate future time measured from the present moment. "Ago" is incorrect because it indicates past time. "Since" is incorrect because it refers to time passed from a past event to the present.

Item 24 since Explanation: "Since" is used to indicate the time that has passed from a specific event until now. "Ago" is incorrect because it means a specific time before now, not ongoing time. "Before" is incorrect because it does not indicate ongoing time from a past event.
